1. WINDOWS FUNDAMENTALS 1-3

DATE: 28/01/2026

Aim:

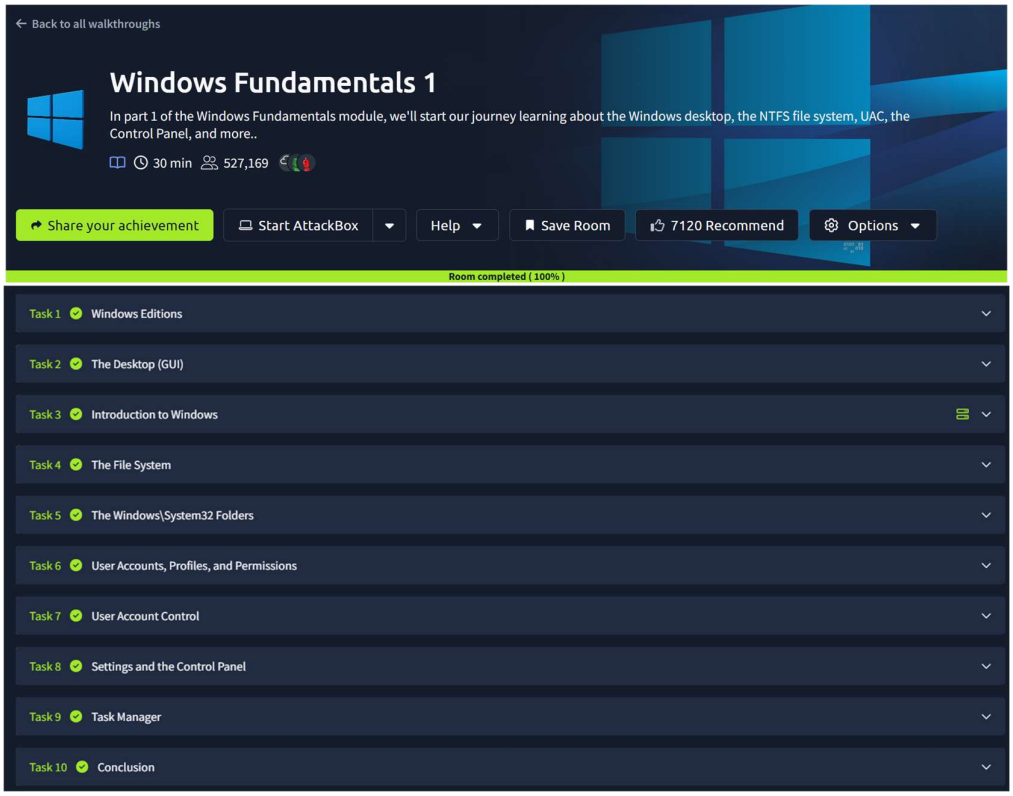
To learn about the Windows desktop, the NTFS file system, UAC, the Control Panel, System Configuration, UAC Settings, Resource Monitoring, the Windows Registry, built-in Microsoft tools that help keep the device secure, such as Windows Updates, Windows Security, BitLocker and more.

Procedure:

1. Log into TryHackMe and open Windows Fundamentals 1, 2, and 3 rooms.
2. Study the Windows interface, desktop environment, and navigation.
3. Understand the file system, directories, and file management.
4. Explore system tools such as Task Manager, Control Panel, and Registry Editor.
5. Learn about user accounts, permissions, and basic security settings.
6. Analyze system configuration and administrative features.
7. Complete the tasks and answer the questions in all rooms.
8. Review the concepts and confirm completion.

Tasks:

Windows Fundamentals 1



TASK 1 – Windows Editions

Task 1 Windows Editions

The Windows operating system has a long history dating back to 1985, and currently, it is the dominant operating system in both home use and corporate networks. Because of this, Windows has always been targeted by hackers & malware writers.

Windows XP was a popular version of Windows and had a long-running. Microsoft announced Windows Vista , which was a complete overhaul of the Windows operating system. There were many issues with Windows Vista. It wasn't received well by Windows users, and it was quickly phased out.

When Microsoft announced the end-of-life date for Windows XP, many customers panicked. Corporations, hospitals, etc., scrambled and tested the next viable Windows version , which was Windows 7, against many other hardware and devices. Vendors had to work against the clock to ensure their products worked with Windows 7 for their customers. If they couldn't, their customers had to break their agreement and find another vendor that upgraded their products to work with Windows 7. It was a nightmare for many, and Microsoft took note of it.

Windows 7, as quickly as it was released soon after, was marked with an end of support date. Windows 8.x came and left and it was short-lived, like Vista.

Then arrived Windows 10 followed by Windows 11, which is the current Windows operating system version for desktop computers.

Windows 11 comes in 2 flavors, Home and Pro. You can read the difference between the Home and Pro here.

Even though we didn't talk about servers, the current version of the Windows operating system for servers is Windows Server 2025.

Many critics like to bash on Microsoft, but they have made long strides to improve the usability and security with each new version of Windows .

Note : The Windows edition for the attached VM is Windows Server 2019 Standard, as seen in **System Information** .

Update : As of June 2021, Microsoft announced the retirement dates for Windows 10 here .

" *Microsoft will continue to support at least one Windows 10 Semi-Annual Channel until October 14, 2025* ".

As of October 5th, 2021 - Windows 11 now is the current Windows operating system for end-users. Read more about Windows 11 here .

Answer the questions below

What encryption can you enable on Pro that you can't enable in Home?

BitLocker ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 2 - The Desktop (GUI)

Answer the questions below

Which selection will hide/disable the Search box?

Hidden ✓ Correct Answer

Which selection will hide/disable the Task View button?

Show Task View button ✓ Correct Answer

Besides Clock and Network, what other icon is visible in the Notification Area?

Action Center ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 3 – Introduction to Windows

Answer the questions below

Read above and start the virtual machine.

No answer needed ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 4 - The File System

Answer the questions below

What is the meaning of NTFS?

New Technology File System ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 5 – The Windows/System32 Folder

Answer the questions below

What is the system variable for the Windows folder?

%windir% ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 6 - User Accounts , Files and Permissions

Answer the questions below

What is the name of the other user account?

tryhackmebilly ✓ Correct Answer

What groups is this user a member of?

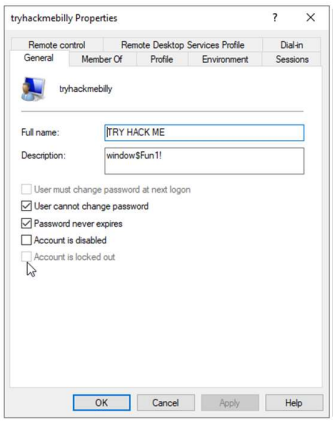
Remote Desktop Users,Users ✓ Correct Answer

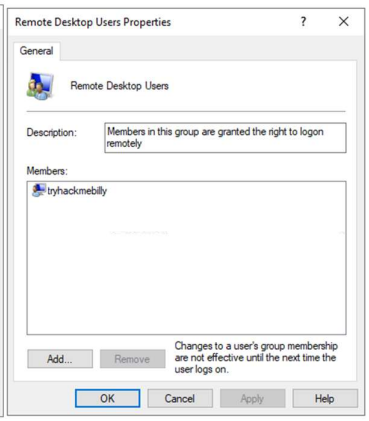
What built-in account is for guest access to the computer?

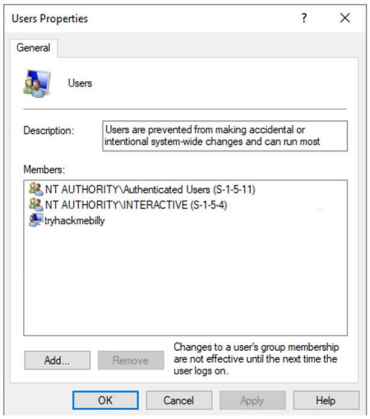
Guest ✓ Correct Answer

What is the account description?

window$Fun1! ✓ Correct Answer







TASK 7 – User Account Control

Answer the questions below

What does UAC mean?

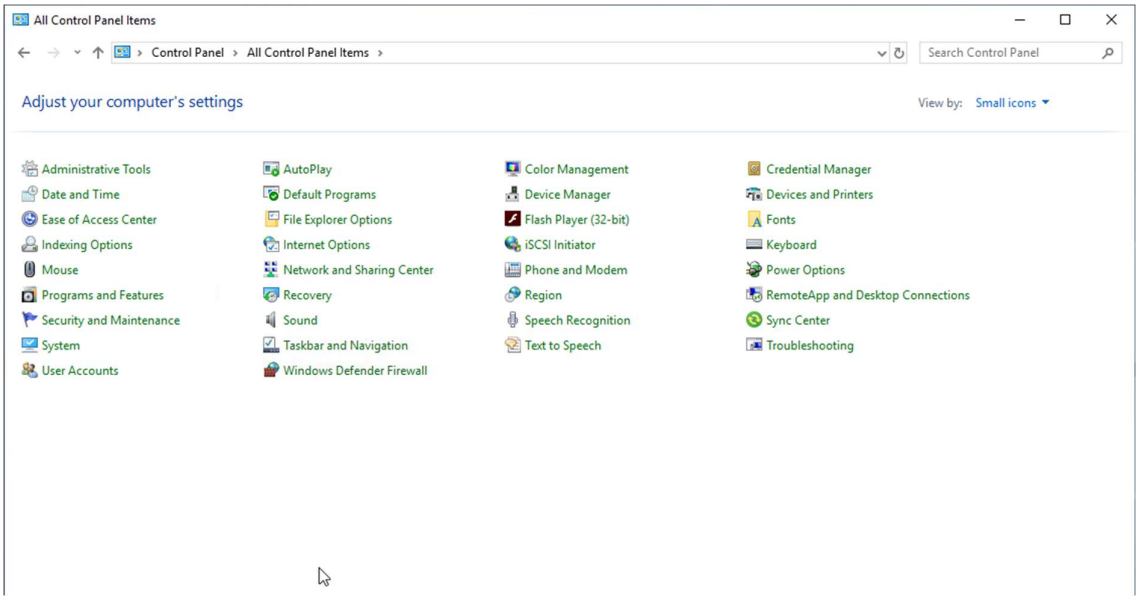
User Account Control ✓ Correct Answer

TASK 8 – Settings and Control Panel

Answer the questions below

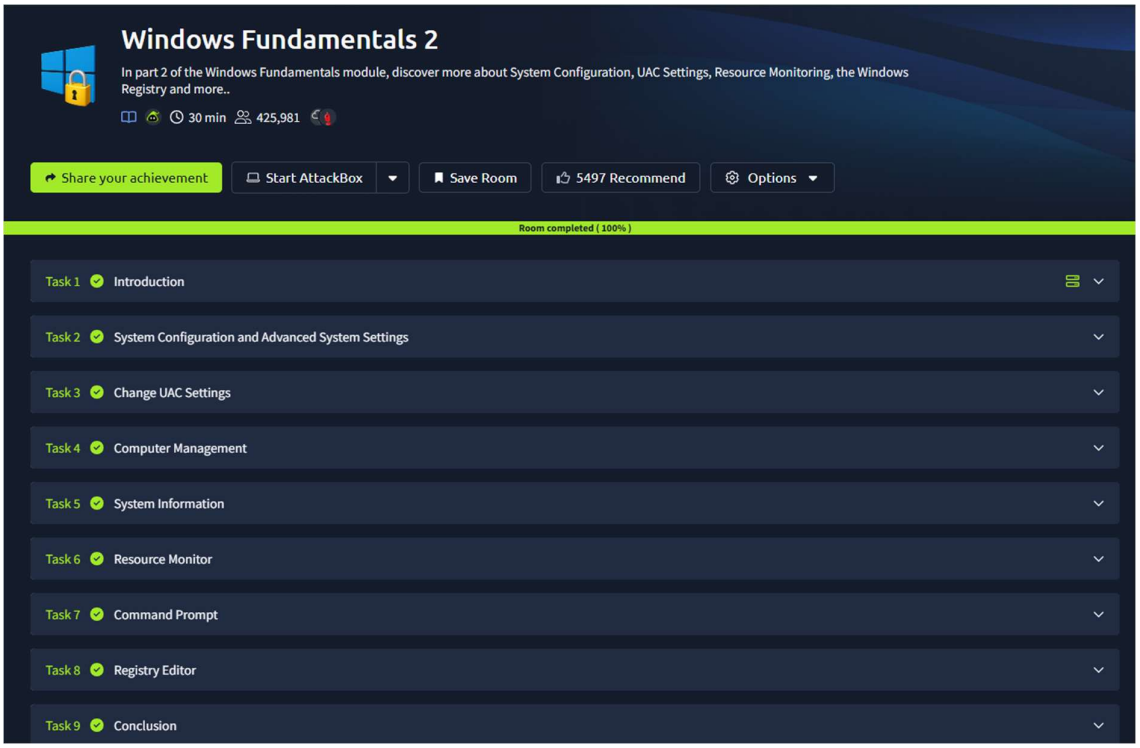
In the Control Panel, change the view to **Small icons**. What is the last setting in the Control Panel view?

Windows Defender Firewall ✓ Correct Answer



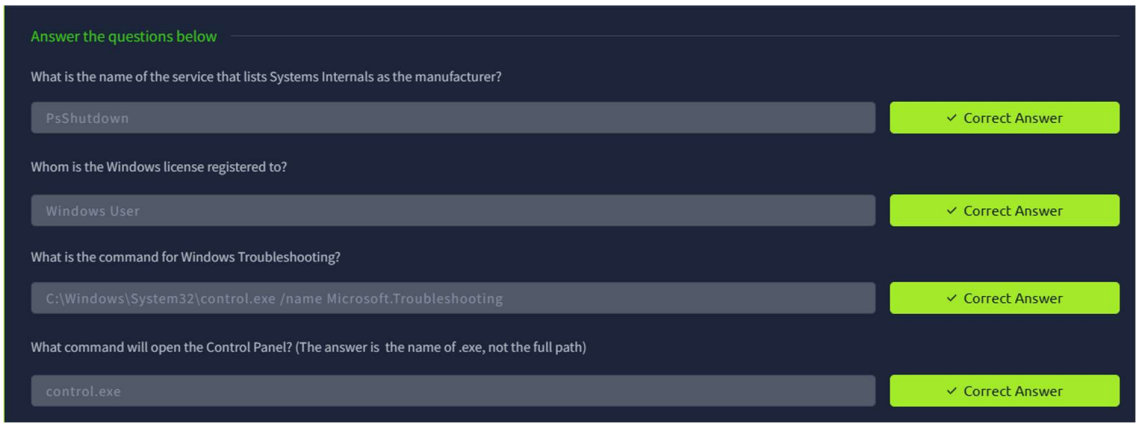
TASK 9 – Task Manager

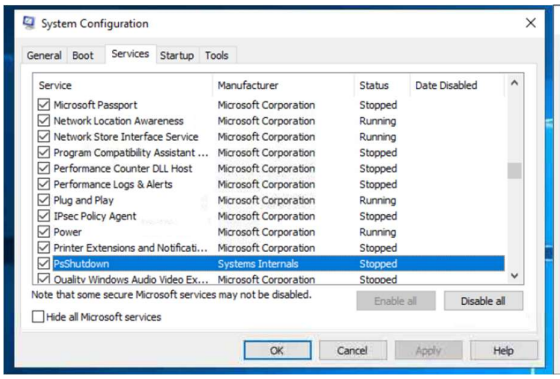
Windows Fundamentals 2

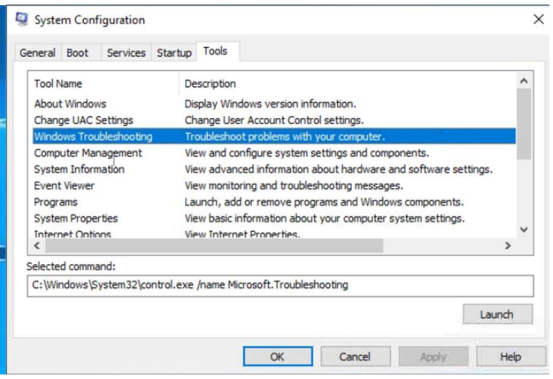


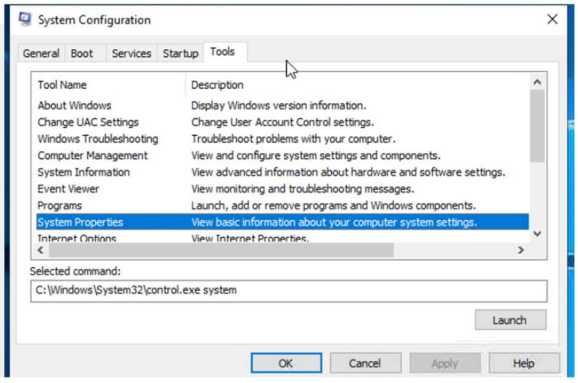
TASK 1 - Introduction

TASK 2 – System Configuration and Advanced System Settings

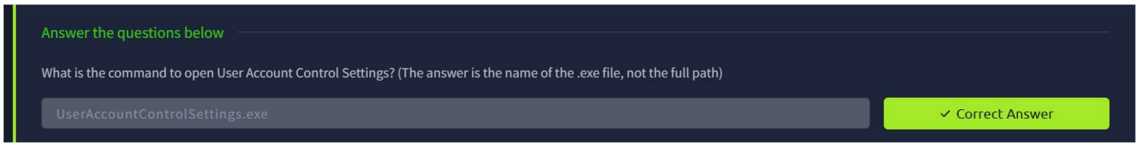


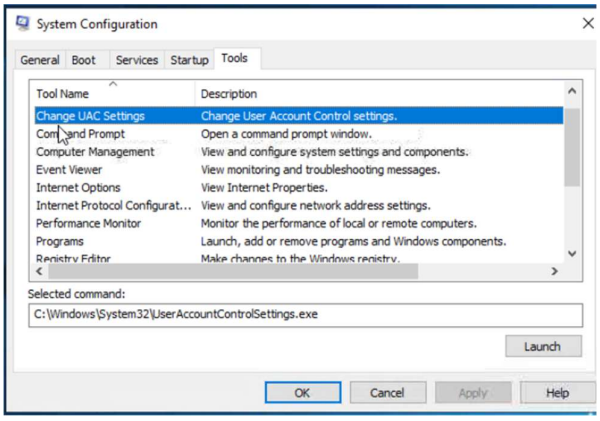






TASK 3 - Change UAC Settings





TASK 4 - Computer Management

Answer the questions below

What is the command to open Computer Management?
(The answer is the name of the .msc file, not the full path)

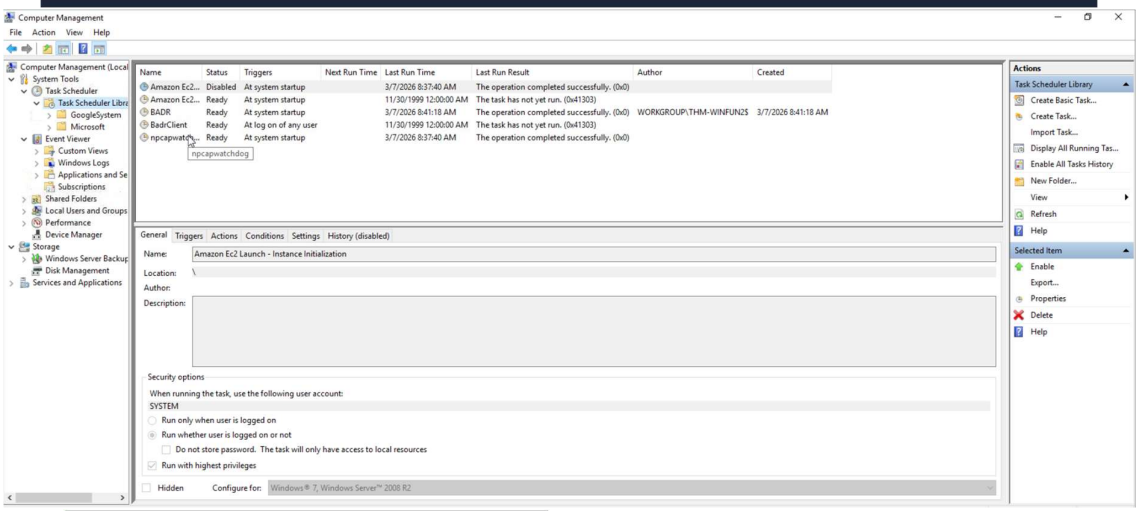
compmgmt.msc — ✓ Correct Answer

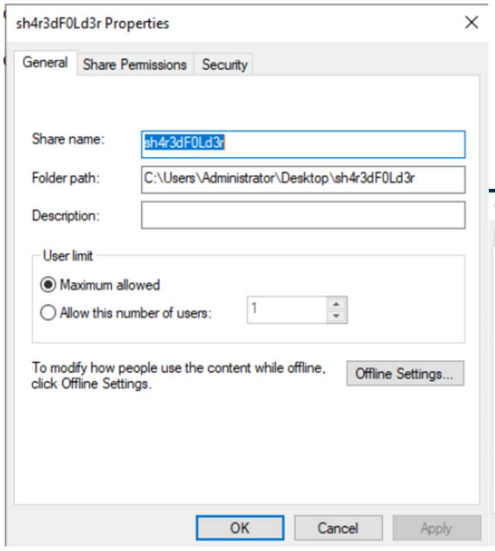
When is the `npcapwatchdog` scheduled task set to run at?

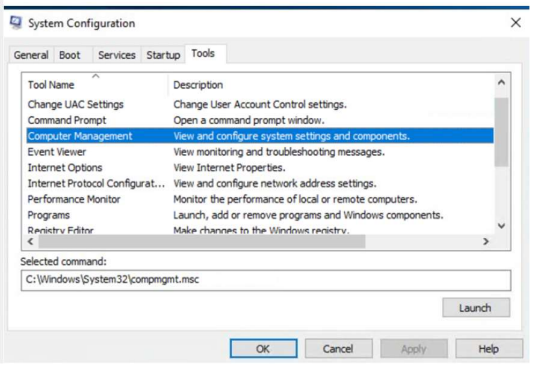
At system startup — ✓ Correct Answer

What is the name of the hidden folder that is shared?

sh4r3dF0Ld3r — ✓ Correct Answer







TASK 5 – System Information

Answer the questions below

What is the command to open System Information? (The answer is the name of the .exe file, not the full path)

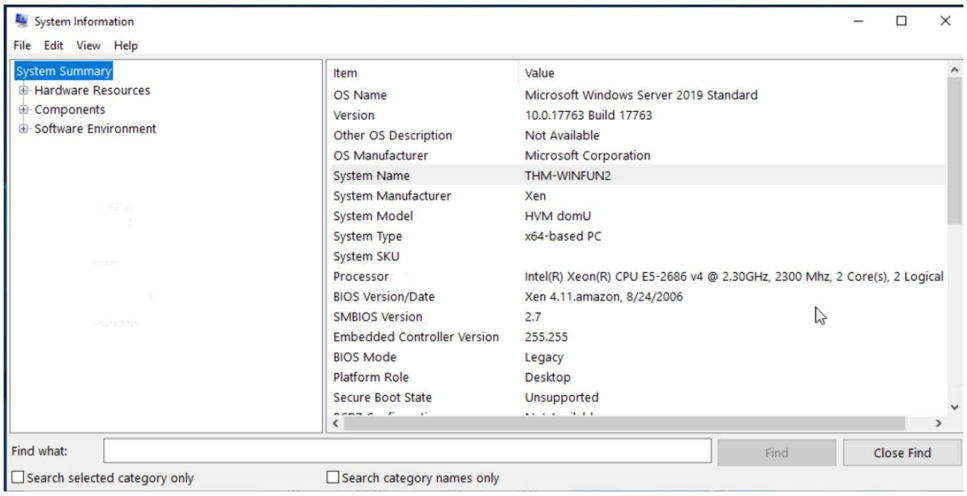
msinfo32.exe ✓ Correct Answer

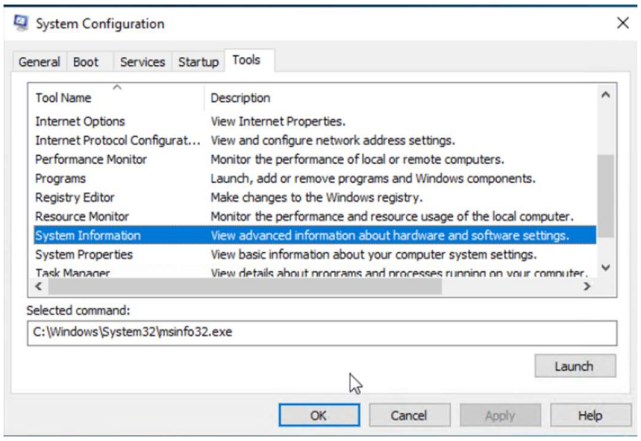
What is listed under System Name?

THM-WINFUN2 ✓ Correct Answer

Under Environment Variables, what is the value for ComSpec?

%SystemRoot%\system32\cmd.exe ✓ Correct Answer



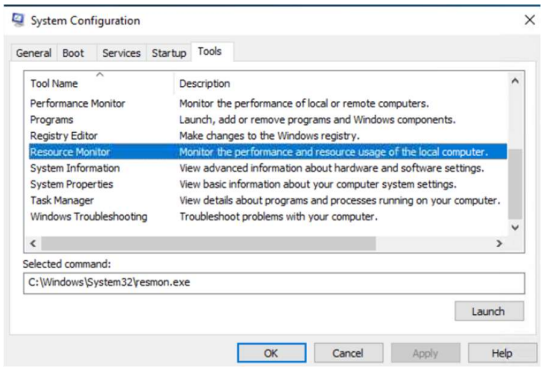


TASK 6 – Resource Monitor

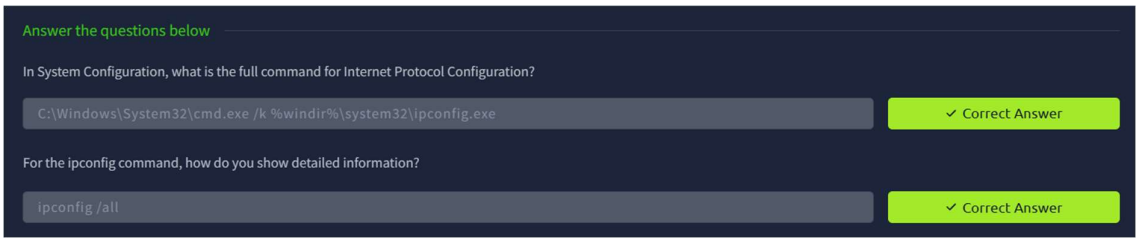
Answer the questions below

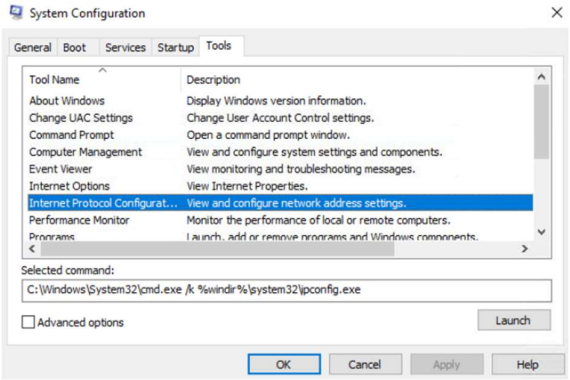
What is the command to open Resource Monitor? (The answer is the name of the .exe file, not the full path)

resmon.exe ✓ Correct Answer

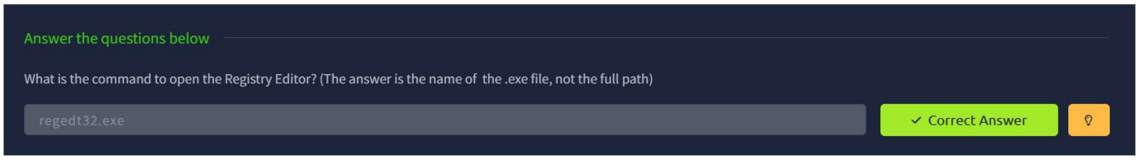


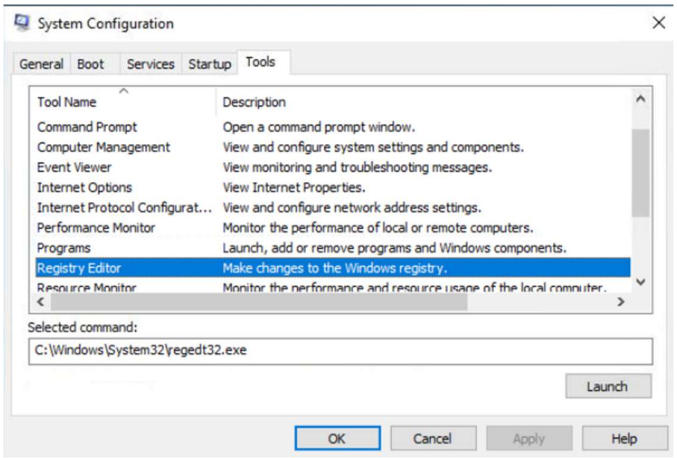
TASK 7 – Command Prompt





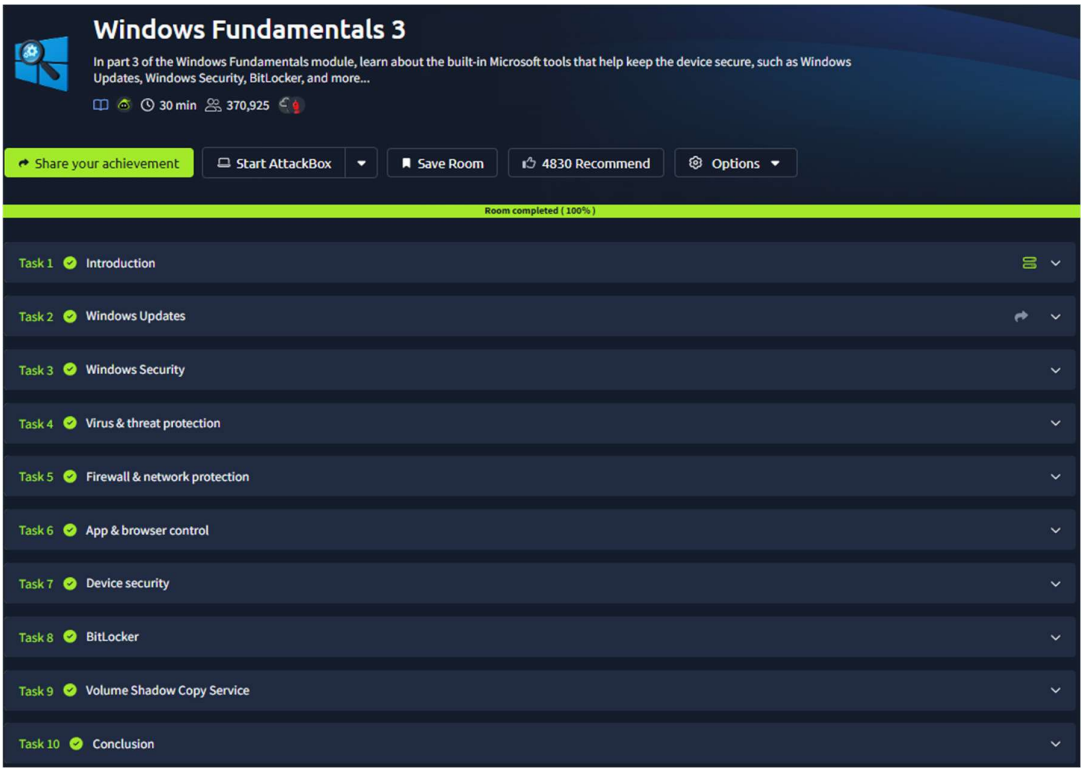
TASK 8 – Registry Editor





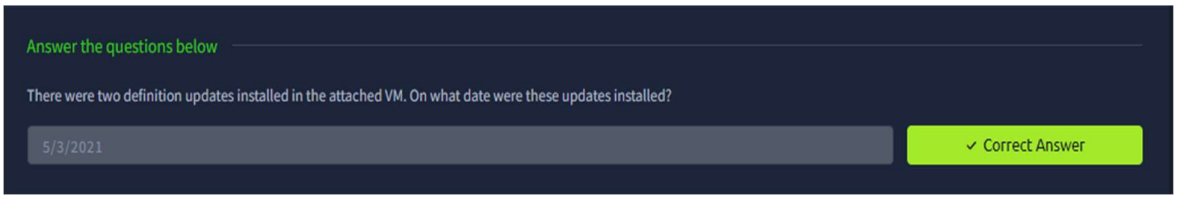
TASK 9 – Conclusion

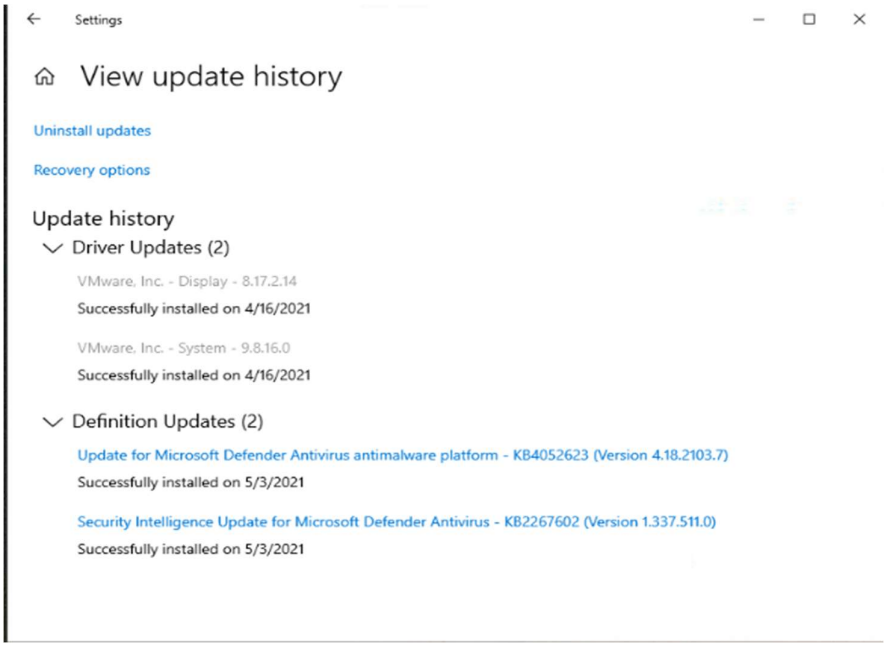
Windows Fundamentals 3



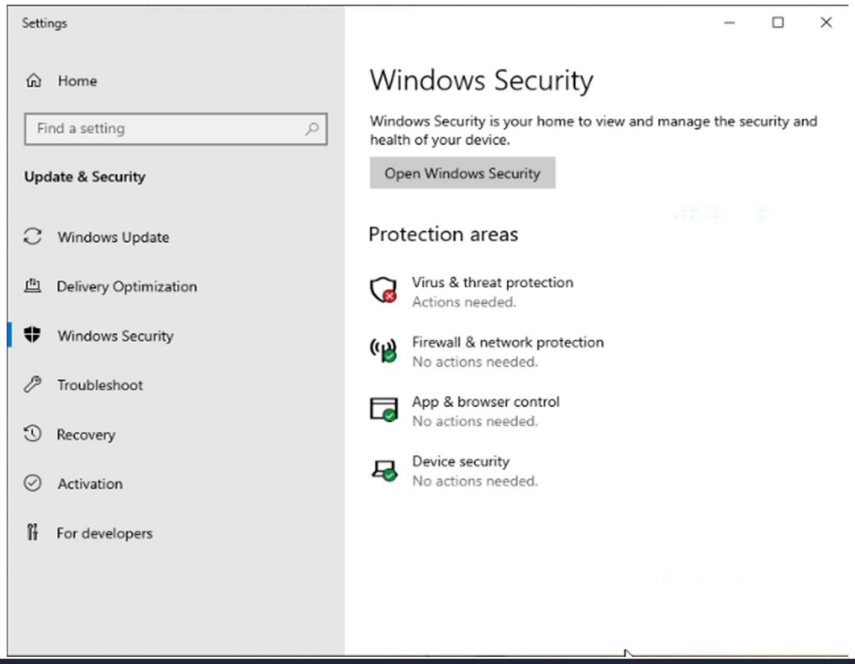
TASK 1 - Introduction

TASK 2 – Windows Updates

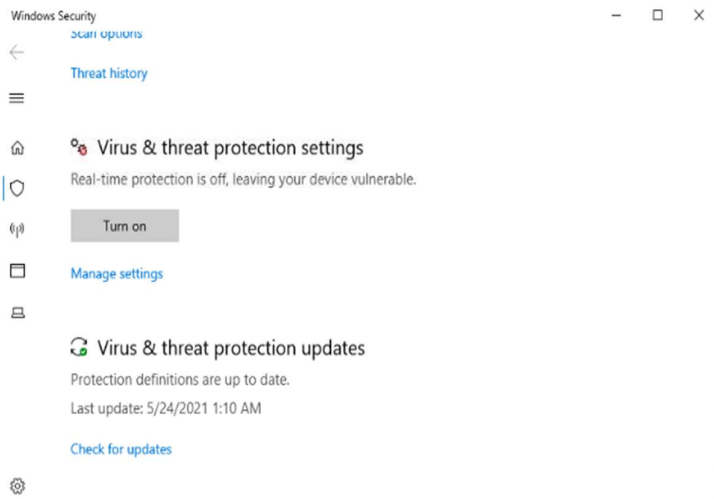




TASK 3 – Windows Security



TASK 4 – Virus and Threat Protection



TASK 5 – Firewall & Network Protection

TASK 6 -App & Browser Control

TASK 7 - Device Security

TASK 8 - Conclusion

Result:

Thus the TryHackMe rooms Windows Fundamentals 1,2,3 were completed successfully.